

Antibiotic Awareness

Source basis: World Health Organization - Antimicrobial Resistance

Source URL: <https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/antimicrobial-resistance>

Created: 30 July 2026

Key facts

- Antibiotics treat certain bacterial infections. They do not treat viral infections such as most colds and flu.
- Use antibiotics only when prescribed by a qualified clinician.

Safe use

- Take an antibiotic exactly as directed and do not share leftover medicines.
- Contact the prescriber or pharmacist if side effects, allergy symptoms, or concerns occur. Seek urgent help for severe allergic symptoms or trouble breathing.

This fact sheet provides general health information only. It is not a diagnosis, prescription, or substitute for advice from a licensed clinician or pharmacist. For an emergency, seek urgent local medical help. In India, call 112.